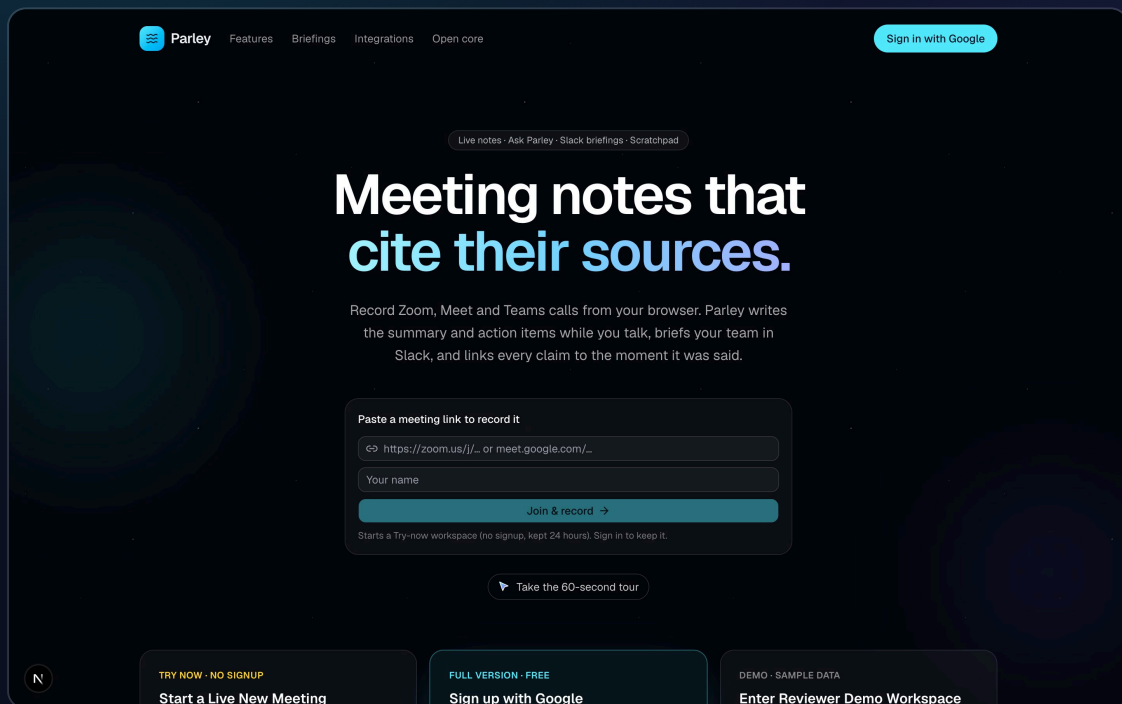




HANDOVER · SEPTEMBER 2026

Meeting notes that cite their sources.

An open-core clone of Fathom, built in 24 hours on Next.js, Vercel and Neon Postgres. This guide covers how to use Parley and set up each integration (Part 1), then how it compares with Fathom and why (Part 2).



Live app parley-smoky.vercel.app

Source github.com/yashg16422-design/parley

Stack Next.js 16 · React 19 · Neon Postgres · Deepgram · Claude / ChatGPT / Hugging Face

Using Parley

1. Pick a way in

The landing page offers three ways in, with the differences spelled out side by side.

Mode	For	Data
Try now	A quick test, no signup	Private workspace, deleted after 24 hours unless you sign in
Sign in with Google	Real use	Kept until you delete it, on every device. Try-now recordings carry over
Reviewer demo	Exploring with sample data	Maya Chen's 20 meetings, shared by all visitors

TRY NOW · NO SIGNUP

Start a Live New Meeting

Everything works right away. Your workspace and recordings are deleted after 24 hours unless you sign in.

Try now →

FULL VERSION · FREE

Sign up with Google

Your recordings, notes, scratchpads, API keys, calendar and Slack briefings are saved to your account, on every device.

Continue with Google

DEMO · SAMPLE DATA

Enter Reviewer Demo Workspace

Explore Maya Chen's 20 recorded meetings, an 8-person hour-long call, clips and a busy calendar. Shared by every visitor.

Open the demo →

	Try now	Full version	Demo
Record calls and get AI notes	✓	✓	✓
Ask Parley, live notes, scratchpad, clips	✓	✓	✓
How long your data is kept	24 hours	Until you delete it	Shared sample data
Your own API keys, calendar, access tokens	—	✓	Shared
Sign-in needed	No	Google	No
Same workspace on every device	—	✓	—

Figure 1. The three modes and what each one keeps.

2. Take the guided tour

Take the 60-second tour moves a gradient cursor to each part of the landing page and explains it. The last step opens a workspace, where the dashboard tour continues. It also starts on a first visit, and the **Tour** button replays it. Arrow keys move between steps; Esc closes.

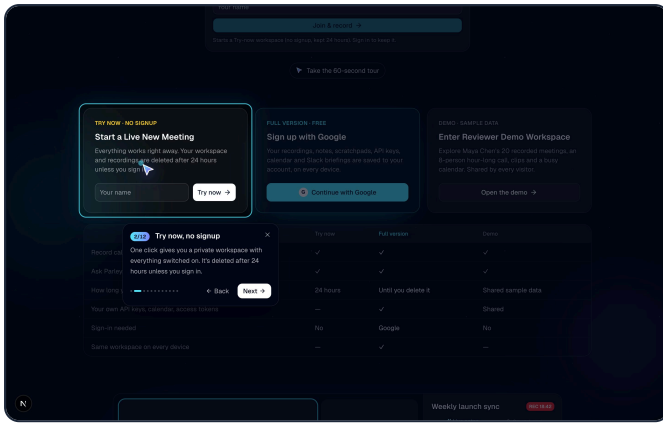


Figure 2. Landing tour, step 2 of 12.

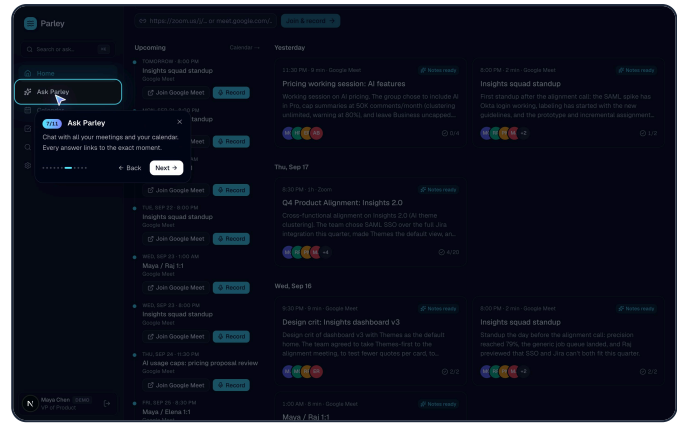


Figure 3. Dashboard tour, pointing at Ask Parley.

3. The dashboard

Recent calls with AI summaries, attendees and action-item progress; your upcoming calendar with one-click **Record**; the search/ask bar (⌘K); and a box to record by meeting link.

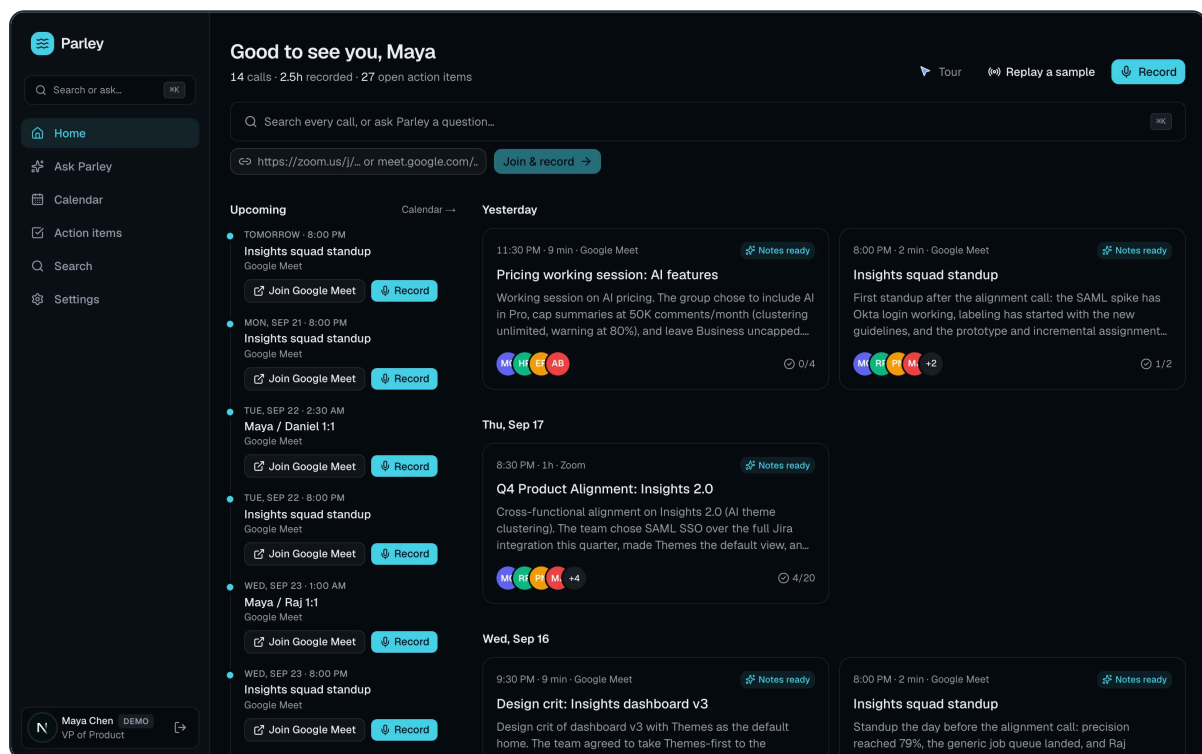


Figure 4. Home: stats, upcoming calls and meeting cards.

4. Record a call

1. Paste a Zoom, Meet or Teams link, or press **Record**. Starting from an upcoming calendar event keeps its attendees and agenda.
2. Tick **Also capture the meeting tab's audio**, pick the meeting's tab and turn on **Also share tab audio**. Your mic is added automatically.
3. Tick the consent box (you can copy a notice to paste into the meeting chat), then **Record live microphone**.
4. During the call:
 - The transcript streams in with speakers.
 - **Live notes** collect decisions, action items and questions.

- **Scratchpad** holds your private notes.
- **Pause** and **Leave** (end or discard) are always there.

5. **End** the call: notes are ready in seconds to a minute, depending on the model.

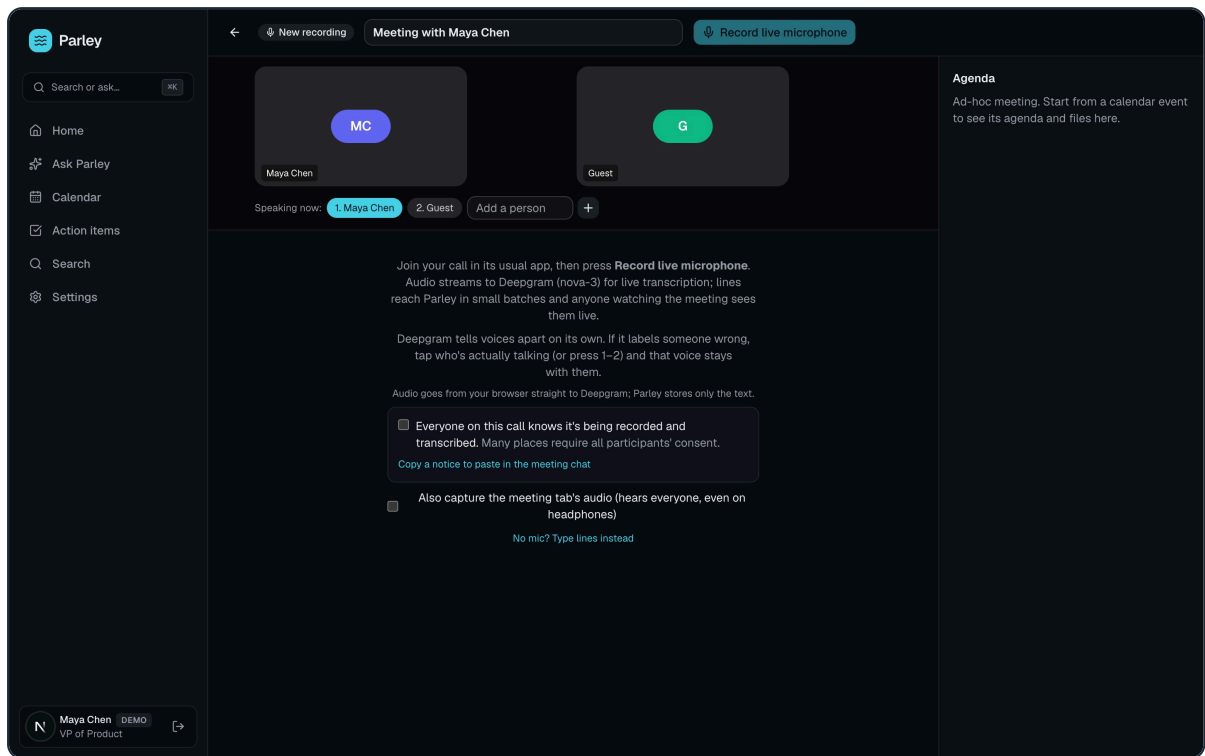


Figure 5. The recording room: consent, tab audio and speaker labels.

No call to hand? **Replay a sample** plays a real recorded meeting at up to 60x speed, with live notes building as it goes.

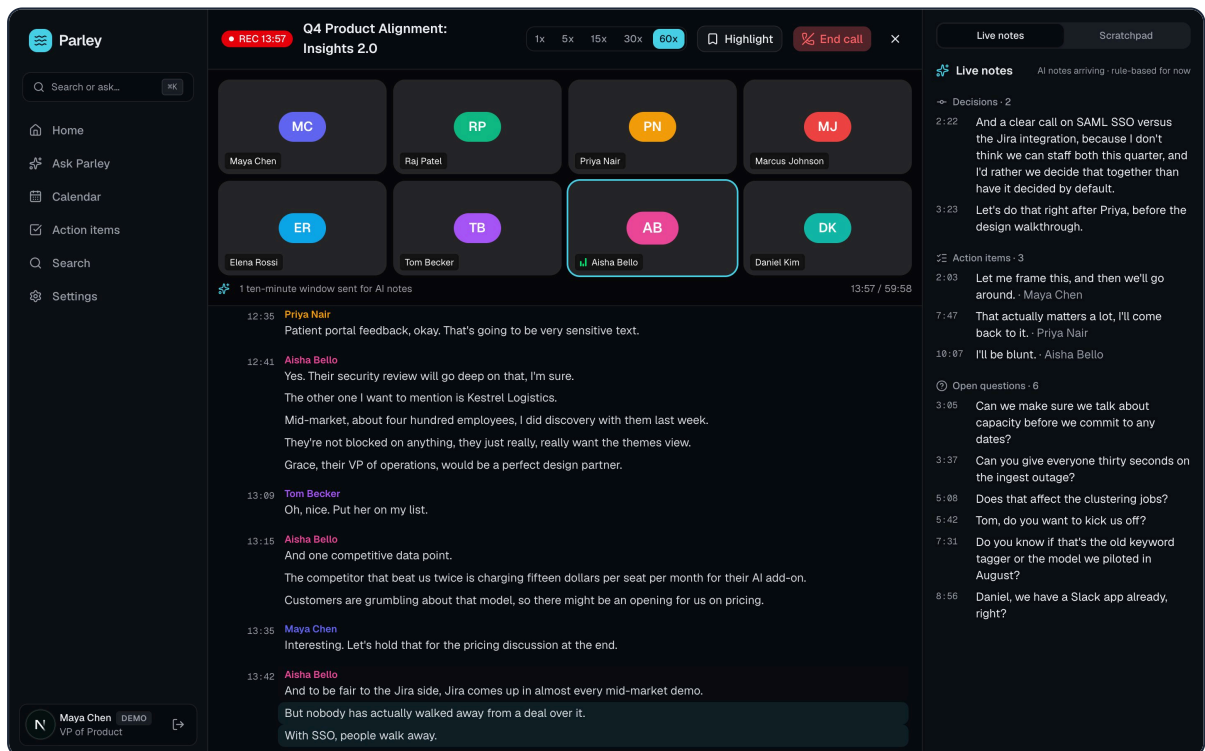


Figure 6. A call in progress: speaker tiles, transcript and live notes.

5. After the call

The meeting page has the summary in your chosen template, action items with owners and due dates, highlights, shareable clips and the full transcript. Every point shows timestamps that jump to the exact line.

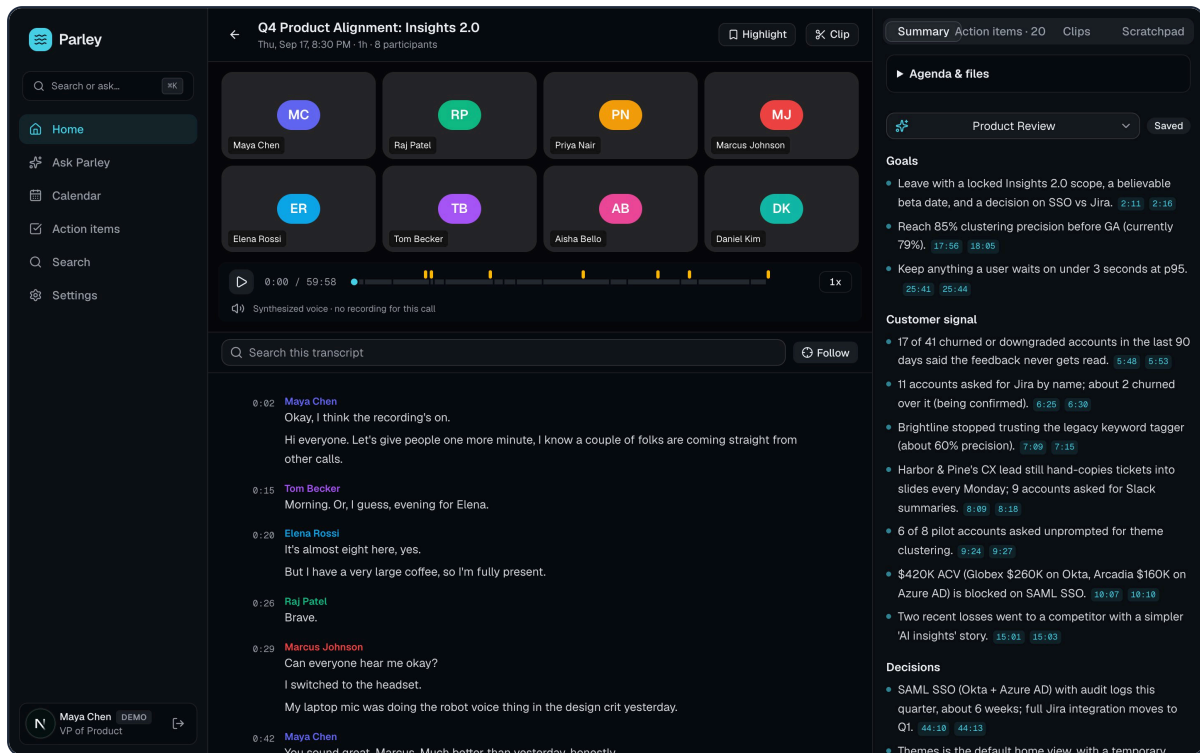


Figure 7. Meeting page: every summary point cites its moments (e.g. 10:07, 10:10).

Ask Parley answers questions across all meetings and your calendar. Each sentence cites its source, and anything it can't back up is removed. **Search** is synonym-aware: "single sign-on" also finds SSO and SAML.

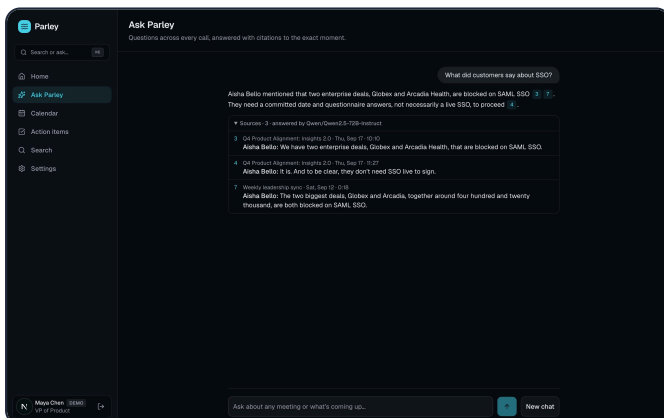


Figure 8. Ask Parley: a cited answer, sources listed with the model used.

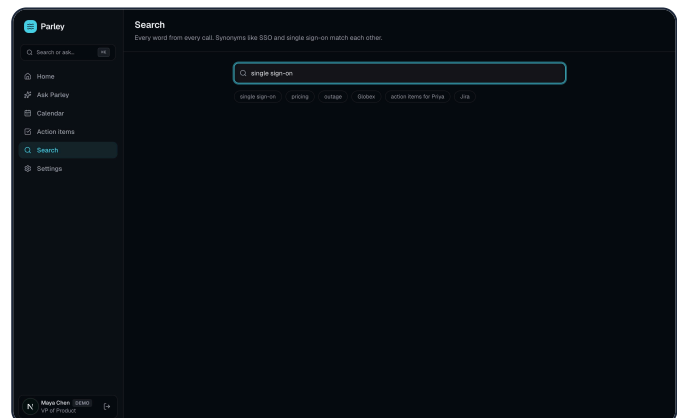


Figure 9. Search across every call.

6. Connect your calendar

No Google sign-in needed: paste your calendar's secret iCal address and the next 30 days of Zoom, Meet and Teams calls appear, ready to record in one click.

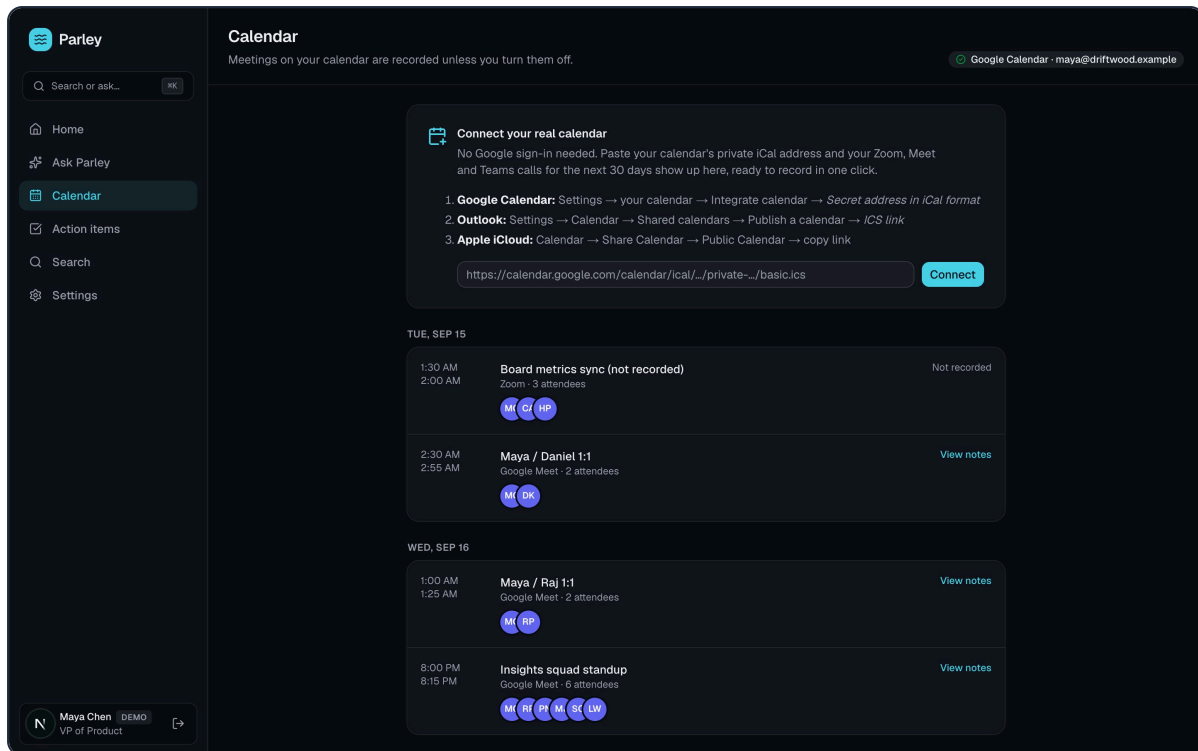


Figure 10. Calendar: connect with an iCal link; events show recorded or not.

7. Plugin setup (Settings)

Each key or token is checked live before saving, stored encrypted and never shown again. Only signed-in accounts can save them. Your key always wins over the server's default.

Plugin	Where to get it	What it does
Claude · ChatGPT · Hugging Face	console.anthropic.com · platform.openai.com · huggingface.co → Access Tokens	Writes notes, summaries and answers on your key. Tried in that order; without one, the server's default model is used
Deepgram	console.deepgram.com → API Keys (Member role)	Live transcription on your own key
Slack	api.slack.com/apps → Create app → Incoming Webhooks → Add to channel	A briefing when notes are ready: summary, agenda, talk time, action items with owners
Notion	notion.so/profile/integrations → new integration; then in the database → Connections → add it	A page per meeting with action items as checkboxes
HubSpot	Settings → Integrations → Private apps (contacts read + write)	A note on each attendee who's a contact. Record from a calendar event so emails are known
Calendar	Google Calendar → your calendar's settings → <i>Secret address in iCal format</i>	Upcoming calls, agendas and attendees; join and record
API + MCP	Settings → Access tokens → scope read	REST API and MCP server for Claude, Cursor or scripts

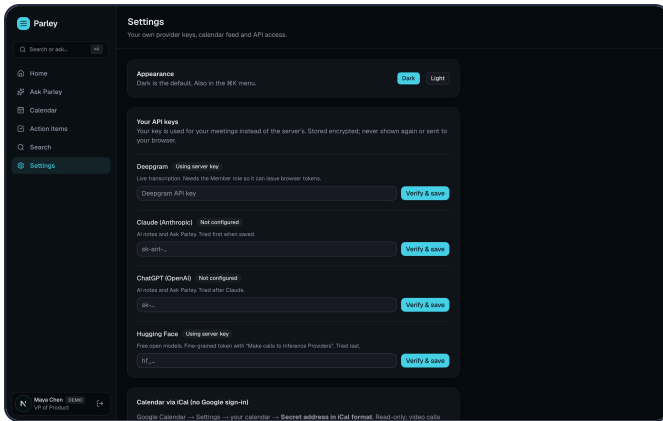


Figure 11. Your own model and Deepgram keys.

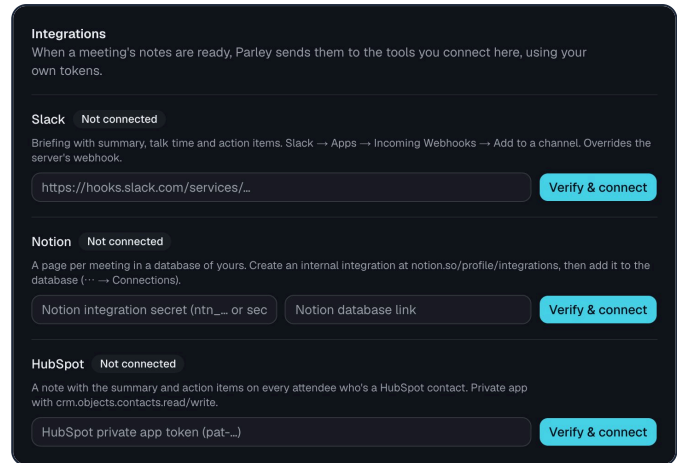


Figure 12. Slack, Notion and HubSpot, each verified before saving.

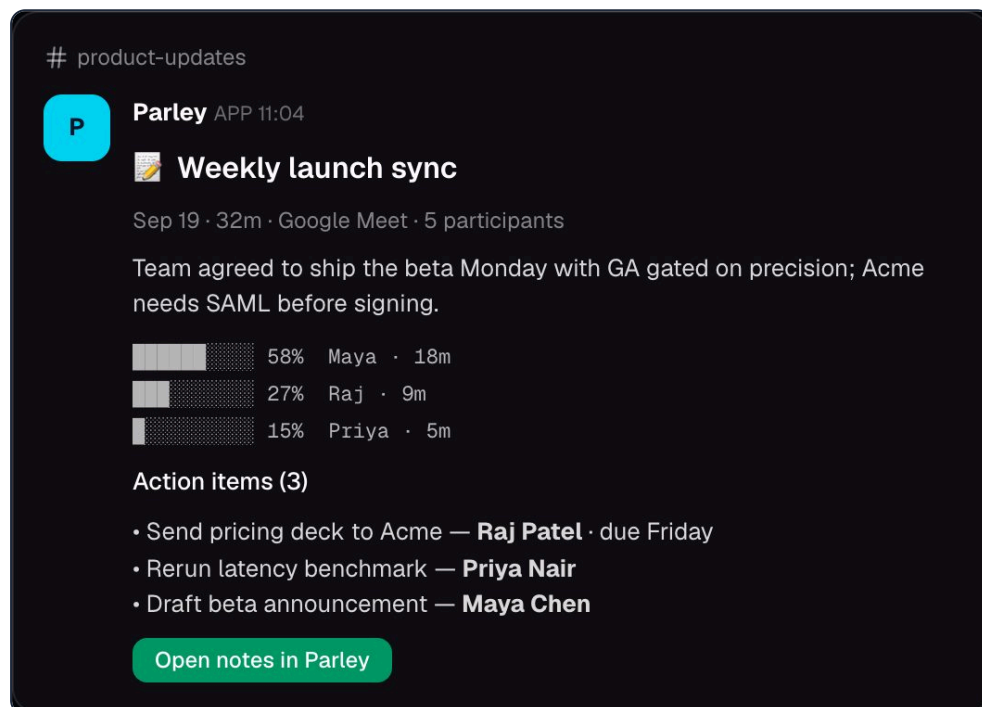


Figure 13. The Slack briefing: summary, talk time and action items with owners.

Connect Claude Code (or any MCP client) with a read token:

```
claude mcp add --transport http parley https://parley-smoky.vercel.app/api/mcp --header "Authorization: Bearer parley_pat_..."
```

Then ask, for example, "What action items came out of today's call?". Tools: `search_meetings`, `ask_parley`, `list_meetings`, `get_meeting`, `list_action_items`. REST: `/api/v1/meetings`, `/meetings/:id`, `/action-items`, `/search`, `/ask`.

8. Your data

Export everything as one JSON file, auto-delete meetings after 30, 90 or 365 days, delete your account, and review sign-ins, key changes and deliveries under **Security activity**. The [/privacy](#) page lists what's stored and where.

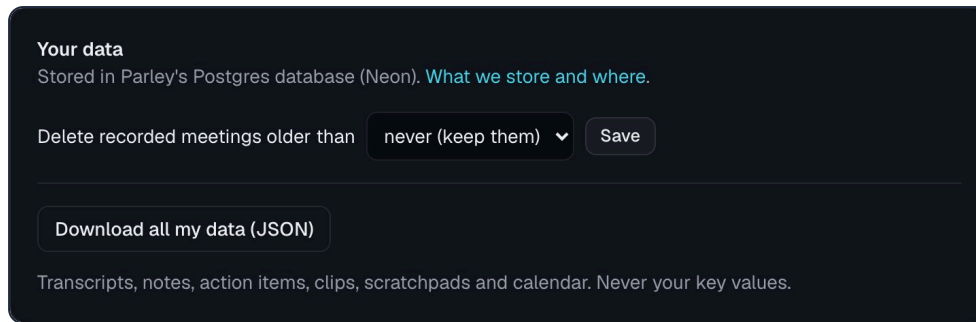


Figure 14. Retention and export.

9. Running it (owner)

- **Deploy:** `npx vercel deploy --prod`. Environment variables are listed in the README; never change `PARLEY_SECRET_KEY`.
- **Tests:** `npm run typecheck` & `npm run db:verify` needs no keys or network.
- **Google sign-in:** the OAuth client must list `https://parley-smoky.vercel.app/api/auth/google/callback`. Publish the consent screen so any Gmail account can sign in.
- **Speed:** the default model is Hugging Face's free Qwen 72B. The first live notes take about 45 s and summaries up to a minute. Adding `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` in Vercel makes Claude the default: faster, with more reliable citations.

Parley vs Fathom

Where Parley matches Fathom

Fathom	Parley
Records Zoom, Meet, Teams	Yes, from the browser tab (no bot)
Transcript with speakers	Yes, Deepgram nova-3 with speaker detection
AI summary with templates	Yes, template-driven, each point cited
Action items with owners	Yes, with due dates and a link to the moment
Highlights and clips	Yes (audio + transcript clips)
Ask Fathom	Ask Parley , across meetings <i>and</i> calendar
Search across calls	Yes, synonym-aware
Slack, Notion, HubSpot	Yes, on each user's own tokens
Calendar integration	Yes, via iCal link

Where Parley goes further

Traceable by design

- The model sees numbered transcript lines and must cite them.
- Made-up citations and uncited sentences are removed, not shown.

During the call

- Live notes build while you talk, not only afterwards.
- A private scratchpad sits alongside.

Your models, your bill

- Claude, ChatGPT or free Hugging Face, plus Deepgram, on your own keys.
- Falls back to the server's default model.

Open and programmable

- REST API and MCP server.
- No bot in the call.
- Self-hostable on Vercel + Postgres.

What Fathom has that Parley doesn't, and why

Missing	Why (the step back)
A bot that joins calls	Google Meet has no public way for a bot to hear a live call; its live-audio API is a developer preview that needs enrollment. Zoom bots need Zoom's app review and run a full client on a server. Teams media bots are Windows-only on Azure. A bot also stays in an hour-long call, which short-lived serverless functions can't host. Services like Recall.ai solve this but charge per meeting hour. Browser capture works on any call today at no extra cost.
Video recording	Notes come from what people say, and the transcript carries nearly all of it. Audio is about 15–20 MB an hour; 720p video is 600–700 MB, which would fill the free 0.5 GB database in one call. Video also needs a paid video service, heavier capture that phones can't do, and more sensitive data. Vision models cost far more per minute than text, and most free models are text-only, which would break bring-your-own-model.
Google / Outlook calendar sign-in	Calendar read access is a "sensitive" Google permission that needs app verification (domain, privacy policy, demo video, review), taking days to weeks. Until then, users see an "unverified app" warning and only 100 test users can sign in. A secret iCal address gives the same events today with no review, updated on a schedule instead of instantly. Sign-in itself uses only name, email and photo, which need no review.
Deep CRM sync	Salesforce and CRM marketplace apps need partner review. Parley writes notes to HubSpot contacts with the user's own private-app token instead.
Teams, admin, SSO, SOC 2, HIPAA	Organisation features and outside audits, not a 24-hour build. Parley ships the controls those audits look for (export, retention, deletion, audit log, encrypted secrets, consent notice) but no certification.

The core choice: notes come from words, so Parley is a speech-to-text pipeline running in the browser and on serverless functions. That keeps storage roughly 40× smaller than video, makes live notes fast and cheap, works with any AI model, and needs no approval from Zoom or Google to start.

Next steps, if continued

1. A meeting bot through Recall.ai, behind a per-hour cost switch.
2. Move audio to Vercel Blob or R2 and enable the Mux video pipeline that's already designed.
3. Complete Google's app verification for true calendar sync.
4. Team workspaces with shared meetings and roles.
5. Store Ask Parley chat history in the database. Today it lives in the browser tab session.